

SPRING INTO LIFE ASSEMBLY 1

SUPER SEEDS

SONG CHOICES:

- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- Full Of The Joys! ● Because It's Springtime! ● It's A Spring Thing!
- Songbird ● As The Sun Rises

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Images on PowerPoint as per Engage activity ● A flower bulb, acorn or large seed ● Bible passage

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To consider the potential that God has built into seeds

ENGAGE

DISPLAY a slide containing five images of spring growth, e.g. buds, chicks, new leaves, a sapling, daffodils AND an image of a pebble or rock.

ASK Which is the odd one out and why?

DISCUSS the characteristics of living things, e.g. growing or moving; food or water; breathe or respire; reproduction in order to conclude that the pebble is the odd one out. (Use *scientific terms as age appropriate.*)

WONDER

INVITE children to hold up a variety of seeds or bulbs for the assembly to see, e.g. a flower bulb, an acorn, an avocado stone or a large seed (e.g. a sunflower seed).

Display a slide of images showing these seeds at maturity (daffodil, oak tree, avocado fruit tree, sunflower).

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK PARTNER What will each of these seeds become? Can you match the seed with its 'mature' picture? How long do you think it will take for these changes to happen?

WITH TALK PARTNER Discuss what the seeds need in order to grow. Why will they grow? Why will a rock or pebble not grow?

GATHER FEEDBACK

BIBLE BIT

The Bible says that God made trees and plants with seeds so that new young plants could grow and become big, mature plants.

READ Genesis chapter 1 v 11

Then God said, 'Let the land sprout with vegetation – every sort of seed-bearing plant, and trees that grow seed-bearing fruit. These seeds will then produce the kinds of plants and trees from which they came.' And that is what happened.

RESPOND

IMAGINE Close your eyes and imagine you are a seed planted deep in the ground. The sun warms the soil around you and the rain provides a lovely drink. You begin to grow. Imagine what it would feel like to emerge from the ground; to stretch up towards the sky. What type of plant are you? How tall will you grow? Will you have a beautiful flower or lovely fruits? Where did you come from? What will you do next?

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Thank you, God.'

For tiny seeds that grow into all kinds of plants;

Thank you, God.

For acorns that become mighty oak trees;

Thank you, God.

For bulbs that grow into yellow daffodils and coloured tulips;

Thank you, God.

For the gift of life;
Thank you, God. Amen.

GO DEEPER

ASK What 'seed' of potential has God 'planted' in you? Perhaps a special gift? For music? Sports? Maybe God has made you skilled at maths or reading. Perhaps you have the gift of a smile. These gifts are like 'seeds' planted in you. Your job is to grow them.

CONSIDER how you can develop the potential you have been given.

ADVANCED PREPARATION

SPRING INTO LIFE ASSEMBLY 2

LIGHT AND COLOUR

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- Full Of The Joys ● A Perfect Day In Spring ● Songbird ● It's A Spring Thing! ● As The Sun Rises ● Because It's Springtime!

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Projected image of a prism refracting light

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To explore light and colour in springtime

ENGAGE

ASK Put up your hand when I say your favourite colour. (*List various colours and include black and white.*) Ascertain approximately the overall favourite colours of the school/class.

WONDER

DISPLAY an image of a prism refracting light into the spectrum of component colours.

EXPLAIN that all colours come from light shining on or through things. Without light, we don't see colour.

ASK How many colours can you see in the image of the spectrum?

I WONDER if you can spot your favourite colour.

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK PARTNER What have you noticed about the amount of daylight in springtime compared to wintertime?

GATHER FEEDBACK

ASK Why might this have happened?

BIBLE BIT

The Bible says that God created light before anything else in the world. Light is important because it brings life and colour to the world.

READ Genesis 1 v 3-4.

Then God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light. And God saw that the light was good. Then He separated the light from the darkness.

RESPOND

IMAGINE a park with lots of bright green grass. What will it smell like if it has just been cut? There is a pond with fluffy, baby ducklings swimming on it. What would it feel like to hold one? Around the pond there are bright yellow daffodils growing under a tree, which is covered in pink blossom. The sky is bright blue.

I wonder what your favourite part of the picture is.

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Thank you, God.'

For bright green grass that grows in the park; **Thank you, God.**

For fluffy yellow ducklings on our ponds and rivers; **Thank you, God.**

For bright yellow daffodils and pink blossom trees; **Thank you, God.**

For all the colours of spring; **Thank you, God.**

For longer days in which to play; **Thank you, God. Amen.**

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER A person who is partially sighted or registered blind may never have seen light or colour clearly, if at all. There may be someone in school who can share how they 'view' colour as sound or vibration.

I WONDER what the word 'colour' might mean to a blind person.

MODERATE PREPARATION

SPRING INTO LIFE ASSEMBLY 3

EXTRA ENERGY

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises ● Sing Yourself A Happy Song ● Full Of The Joys!
- Because It's Springtime!

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Audio clips of different types of birdsong
- Projected images of the birds on a slide
- Images of spring activities as suggested in the 'Talk About' column

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To celebrate the energy of springtime

ENGAGE

Children respond with: 'Wakey, wakey!'

Wakey, wakey!

Wakey, wakey!

Wakey, wakey!

Wakey, wakey!

Wakey, wakey!

Wakey, wakey!

ASK What wakes you up in the morning?

WONDER

LISTEN to three distinct birdsong audio clips for children and...

DISPLAY images to match the three different songs (e.g. robin, wood pigeon, seagull).

WITH TALK

PARTNER Match the songs to the pictures.

I WONDER if you heard the birds singing this morning when you woke up.

I WONDER what the birds might be saying in their songs. Maybe the birds are singing about what they are going to do today.

TALK ABOUT

DISPLAY images of spring activities, e.g. mowing the grass; a cricket or tennis match; maypole dancing; spring cleaning.

WITH TALK

PARTNER What will you do now that the spring has come that you couldn't do in winter?

GATHER FEEDBACK

BIBLE BIT

There is a poem in the Bible called the Song of Songs. We're going to listen to a part that describes the coming of spring.

READ Song of Songs 2 v 11-13 (paraphrased)

Look, the winter is past and the rains are over and gone. The flowers are springing up; the season of singing birds has come and the cooing of turtle doves fills the air. The fig trees are forming fruit and the fragrant vines are blossoming. Wake up and get going my loved one!

RESPOND

Children respond with: 'Wake up! It's springtime!'
(This requires lots of enthusiasm and volume to work well! Pupils could suggest lines to suit context.)

The days are growing longer! **Wake up! It's springtime!**

The birds are laying eggs! **Wake up! It's springtime!**

The leaves are sprouting on the trees! **Wake up! It's springtime!**

Easter eggs are in the shops! **Etc.**

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Amen.'

Thank you Father God for springtime, for the extra energy we have when the daylight hours are longer and the weather is warmer. Help us to use our energy for good; to help others and work hard at all we do. **Amen.**

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER How might we use our extra energy to achieve or start something new this spring? Perhaps we could revisit a New Year's Resolution that has been forgotten; do a new sport or hobby in the lighter evenings; clean or tidy up a room or a cupboard that needs it.

WITH TALK

PARTNER Share ideas and identify any obstacles that might prevent this from happening. How can these be overcome?

MILD PREPARATION

CHANGE ASSEMBLY 1

TURNING OVER A NEW LEAF

SONG CHOICES:

- Songbird
- Because It's Springtime!
- It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To consider how we might turn over a new leaf with God.

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Images of bare, winter trees
- A tree branch/twig showing leaf buds appearing or an image of this
- Zacchaeus Responsive Story, Appendix 1, page 123

ENGAGE

ASK Do you remember what the trees looked like back in December when we were having our Christmas holidays?

DISPLAY image of bare trees in winter.

Where possible show a branch of a tree with leaf shoots appearing (or show an image).

WONDER

Using a tuned percussion instrument, play an ascending scale or use a downloadable SFX.

INVITE

younger children, when they hear the music, to curl up small and pretend to be a leaf bud that is ready to sprout from a branch. As the music plays, they gradually unfold and grow wide, green and glossy.

TALK ABOUT

ASK What does it mean if someone 'turns over a new leaf'?

WITH TALK

PARTNER Come up with two examples of what 'turning over a new leaf' might look like.

GATHER FEEDBACK

BIBLE BIT

This story from the Bible is about someone who met Jesus and turned over a new leaf.

READ the Zacchaeus Responsive Story (Appendix 1, page 123) with the children responding as per instructions in the text.

RESPOND

REFLECT

Think of something about yourself that you would like to change.

PRAYER

Pretend your hand is a leaf. Hold it out in front of you and as we pray, if you would like to turn over a new leaf, turn your hand over as a sign of that.

Thank you God that we can turn over a new leaf and start afresh every morning with you.

Amen.

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER They say that 'Old habits die hard'. Do you think it was easy for Zacchaeus to change his ways?

Why/Why not?

What might have made it easier for Zacchaeus?

WITH TALK

PARTNER How can our friends help us as we attempt to change?

MODERATE PREPARATION

CHANGE ASSEMBLY 2

METAMORPHOSIS

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- Because It's Springtime!
- Caterpillar Munch
- It's A Spring Thing!
- The Tadpole Song

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Images as per 'Engage' column
- YouTube clips as suggested in 'Wonder' column

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To consider that each season of life is to be enjoyed

ENGAGE

DISPLAY a slide of images of a butterfly/moth; a frog/toad; a bee/wasp; a fly.

ASK What do these have in common?
Draw out the response that they started life in a different form.

DISPLAY a slide of the larvae of each insect.

WONDER

WATCH
youtube.com/watch?v=tWt_9yfsL4o

AND WATCH:
youtube.com/watch?v=KCSxQDN37w

Ask for a show of hands as to: Who would prefer to be a tadpole?; Who would prefer to be a frog?

Draw out the idea that any stage of development has good aspects.

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK PARTNER Think of two things that are good about being a baby and two things that are good about being a child of your age.

WITH TALK PARTNER Think of two things that you are looking forward to doing when you are older, e.g. driving a car/travelling a phone/travelling independently.

GATHER FEEDBACK:
Draw out from their ideas that there are benefits at each stage of life, and each stage of life is to be enjoyed.

BIBLE BIT

The Bible talks about each day being a gift from God for us to enjoy.

READ Psalm 118 v 24.
This is the day that the Lord has made. We will rejoice and be glad in it.

RESPOND

REFLECT
Think back to the moment you woke up this morning and in your mind, re-live the events of the day so far. Pause to focus on the bits you have particularly enjoyed.

PRAYER

Dear God, thank you for the gift of life, which we can enjoy today. Help us to make the most of every moment we have, to develop our minds and bodies, to become the best people we can be.
Amen.

GO DEEPER

WITH TALK PARTNER What do you need to do in order to be awake and ready for action at school, ready to learn and to participate?

GATHER FEEDBACK

BE STILL One

minute of stillness

Sit comfortably, close your eyes gently and feel your breath, in, out, in, out. Breathe normally, gently. Feel your tummy moving as you breathe. Feel the floor beneath you. Relax your hands, unclench your fingers. Focus on your breathing, in, out, in, out.

MODERATE PREPARATION

CHANGE ASSEMBLY 3

IT'S CHALLENGING

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- Caterpillar Munch
- It's A Spring Thing!
- The Tadpole Song
- As The Sun Rises

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To explore how change can be difficult

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Coloured toilet roll or green crepe paper
- YouTube clip as suggested in 'Wonder' column

ENGAGE

INVITE Select two volunteer children. One wraps the other, head to toe, in coloured toilet roll or crepe paper. The wrapped child then has to escape from the wrapping.

This represents a moth or butterfly larva emerging from its pupa – designed to show the challenge of this change.

WONDER

DISPLAY clip or slides of an emerging moth etc.

[youtube.com/watch?v=G6ZO5skBmr8](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G6ZO5skBmr8)

EXPLAIN

The moth caterpillar has to work very hard to spin its cocoon

and then to emerge from its pupa. Many changes take place in the pupa to transform it from caterpillar to moth. This struggle builds up the moth's flight muscles ready for when it has wings to fly.

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK

PARTNER Discuss three changes you have experienced (e.g. a new friend/new school/new hobby or sport/moving house/new family member).

GATHER FEEDBACK:

Highlight the changes the children have suggested that are more challenging.

WITH TALK

PARTNER Discuss which of the changes that you have been through was the hardest. Why? What helped you?

RESPOND

REFLECT on a change that you are facing at the moment or about to face.

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Thank you for being with me all the time.'

When I have to start something new;

Thank you for being with me all the time.

When I have to make changes that are difficult;

Thank you for being with me all the time.

When I am afraid of what lies ahead;

Thank you for being with me all the time. Amen.

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER EITHER

Change can be especially difficult for older people, for example when they need more care or they have to go into hospital.

WITH TALK

PARTNER How could you support someone you know who is old, as they face these challenges?

OR CONSIDER

How can we support each other as we face physical changes as we get older? (*Puberty etc. if appropriate.*)

THANKFULNESS ASSEMBLY 1

PEOPLE WHO CARE

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises
- You're The Best Mum For Me!

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Slide of parent images
- YouTube clip of the BBC's *The Greatest Wildlife Show On Earth* or *Dynasties* or images

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To express our gratitude for the people who care about us (to be used around Mother's Day if appropriate)

ENGAGE

DISPLAY slide of images of 'parents', e.g. the Queen, David Beckham, Marge Simpson etc.

ASK What do these people have in common?

Draw out their role as parents.

WONDER

DISPLAY images or a video clip of emperor penguin fathers who protect the egg while the mother penguin hunts for food.

Link to Youtube clip of the BBC's The Greatest Wildlife Show On Earth or Dynasties or images.

I WONDER Can you think of one person who is really important in your life?

TALK ABOUT

REFLECT Think about some of the things your significant person does for you and what he/she means to you.

WITH TALK

PARTNER Tell your partner one thing your important person does for you.

BIBLE BIT

In the Bible there is a description of somebody who might be a little bit like the person you have been thinking about:

READ Proverbs 31 (paraphrased)

This person gets up before dawn to prepare breakfast for the family and plans the day's work. With her own hands she plants a garden. She is energetic, a hard worker, and watches for bargains. She works far into the night! She generously helps those in need. She is a woman of strength and dignity. When she speaks, her words are wise, and kindness is the rule for everything she says. She watches carefully all that goes on throughout her family and is never lazy. Her children stand and bless her.

RESPOND

LISTEN Re-read the Bible passage and replace the female pronouns with 'he' or 'his' etc. asking pupils to listen out for one verse that they agree with, reminding them that the person they are thinking of might be a man or a woman.

PRAYER

Children respond with:
'Thank you, Lord.'

For the important people in my life;
Thank you, Lord.

For the people who cook my food and wash my clothes;
Thank you, Lord.

For the people who work hard to earn money for my family;
Thank you, Lord.

For my special mum;
Thank you, Lord.

For my special dad;
Thank you, Lord. Amen.

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER What could you do or say today to your important person to make them feel special and valued?

WITH TALK PARTNER

In the Bible passage it says that the children stand and bless her. What might the children do or say to show that they 'bless' their mother or father?

MODERATE
PREPARATION

THANKFULNESS ASSEMBLY 2

THE WORLD AROUND

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises
- April Showers

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To appreciate with thankfulness the world around us

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Slide of close-up photos of natural objects e.g. leaf, cell, tree bark or photos by Alberto Ghizzi Panizza.

ENGAGE

If possible, look out of the school hall/room window. If not, ask children to recall or imagine what is outside.

ASK What is the tallest thing you would see? What is the smallest thing you would see? What is out there but is invisible?

GATHER FEEDBACK

WONDER

I WONDER (*In relation to previous answers*) How long has the tree/cell building/mountain been there? How did it get there? Was there something else there before this?

DISPLAY images of close-up photos of natural objects, e.g. leaf, cell, tree bark (or close-up photos of natural objects by Alberto Ghizzi Panizza).

WITH TALK PARTNER Discuss what the images are or could be.

TALK ABOUT

ASK Who has looked out of an aeroplane window?

Who has ever looked at something through a microscope?

WITH TALK PARTNER

What has made you go, 'WOW!'

GATHER FEEDBACK about why these experiences were special. (*Emphasize the details of the natural or man-made world, e.g. colours, shapes, skills.*)

BIBLE BIT

LISTEN AND REFLECT This Bible passage is a poem. Listen carefully as it is read and reflect on who might be speaking.

READ Job chapter 38 (paraphrased): Where were you when I laid the foundations of the earth? Do you know how its dimensions were determined and who did the surveying? What supports its foundations and who laid its cornerstone, as the morning stars sang together and all the angels shouted for joy? Who decided on the boundaries of the seas when they gushed from the depths and said, 'Here shall your proud waves stop.'? Have you ever once commanded the morning to appear and caused the dawn to rise in the east like I have? Have you ever told the daylight to spread to the ends of the earth or have you visited the treasuries of the snow, or seen where hail is made and stored?

REFLECT Think about one of the 'WOW!' moments in the Bible passage and imagine it.

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'WOW! What a wonderful world!'

Praise to God for the tallest trees and highest mountains; **WOW! What a wonderful world!**

Praise to God for microscopic cells and distant stars;

WOW! What a wonderful world!

Praise to God for skyscrapers and tunnels deep beneath our feet; **WOW! What a wonderful world!**

Praise to God for sunsets and dawns, for tides and waves; **WOW! What a wonderful world!**

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER what actions can be taken to protect and enhance the environment around the school.

WITH TALK PARTNER

Think of two 'green' issues that are important.

THANKFULNESS ASSEMBLY 3

HAPPY ENDINGS

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises
- April Showers

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To be thankful that obstacles can be overcome

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Rucksack packed with some heavy books
- The Healing Of The Blind Man Responsive Story, Appendix 2, page 124.
- Video clip as per 'Go Deeper' column

ENGAGE

INVITE a volunteer who considers himself/herself to be fit and strong.

Ask him/her to do eight star jumps.

Then ask the volunteer to wear a rucksack packed with books and do the same jumps.

ASK How did the heavy rucksack hinder his/her jumps? Which task was easier? Which was preferable?

WONDER

ASK Who has ever broken a bone; had chicken pox; had a cold?

I WONDER how it felt when you were poorly. Did the injury/sickness stop you from doing things you wanted to do?

ASK How do you feel now you have recovered or are recovering?

TALK ABOUT

EXPLAIN that different things act as setbacks in our lives, e.g. sickness, sadness, stress, change, separation. These might cause us to feel down and not able to function at top speed – a bit like a heavy rucksack on your back.

WITH TALK PARTNER

Share any setbacks encountered in life. How did you get over them? What steps might be needed to get over them?

BIBLE BIT

This story from the Bible is about a blind man and it shows us that difficult circumstances don't always have to last for ever.

READ The Healing Of The Blind Man Responsive Story, Appendix 2, page 124.

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Jesus, please help me.'

When I am struggling because I don't feel very well; **Jesus, please help me.**

When I am sad and feel lonely; **Jesus, please help me.**

When things are difficult for me and I don't know what to do; **Jesus, please help me.**

Thank you that you always help us to overcome our difficulties and give us a fresh start.
Amen.

GO DEEPER

DISPLAY video clip of people who have overcome obstacles and gone on to achieve great things such as Helen Keller; Nelson Mandela etc.

CONSIDER characteristics needed to overcome difficult situations.

MODERATE PREPARATION

FEELINGS ASSEMBLY 1

FEELING HOPEFUL

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises ● Sing Yourself A Happy Song ● He Is Risen ● Full Of The Joys!

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Long, fat pipe cleaners
- for 'Engage' activity ● Video clip or image to display of a high achiever ● Slide with a quotation from Thomas Edison for 'Go Deeper'

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To consider my hopes and ambitions for the future and what it will take to get there

ENGAGE

INVITE two teams of four people to the front and give each team four long, fat pipe cleaners with which to make the letters 'H', 'O', 'P', 'E' in the fastest time.

EXPLAIN that HOPE is a word we use when we are aiming for something better to happen, e.g. 'I hope it will be sunny tomorrow' OR 'I hope my team will win the match tonight'.

WONDER

DISPLAY an image or video clip of either a top athlete, sportsperson or other high achiever.

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK PARTNER Think of three things that it takes to become a supreme achiever.

GATHER FEEDBACK

Training, practice, study, good diet, repetition, perseverance, making mistakes, risk-taking, natural talent etc.

REFLECT on what you hope to achieve in the future.

BIBLE BIT

This short story from the Bible is a parable that Jesus told. As you listen to it, think about what the merchant had to do to get the best pearl.

READ

Matthew 13 v 45-46, The Parable of the Fine Pearl.

The Kingdom of God is like a merchant on the lookout for choice pearls. When he discovered a pearl of great value he sold everything he owned and bought it!

RESPOND

The pearl merchant had to sell everything he had in order to be able to afford to buy the finest pearl.

REFLECT What might you have to give up in order to achieve your greatest hope or ambition?

EXPLAIN In our prayers today we are going to visualize ourselves achieving our hope or ambition. (Scoring the winning goal; winning a race; being a doctor; being a successful YouTuber; dancing with the Royal Ballet.)

Practise this for a moment or two.

PRAYER

Father God, there are lots of things we hope to achieve in the future and we know it will take hard work and sacrifice.

Let's spend a moment or two **visualizing** ourselves fulfilling our hopes and ambitions.

20-second silence.

Please help us to fulfil our potential and achieve our hopes and ambitions. In Jesus' name. **Amen.**

GO DEEPER

ASK Does it matter if we make mistakes or if we don't understand something straightaway?

DISPLAY

Thomas Edison quote relating to the importance of making mistakes as part of the success journey.

TALK PARTNER How should we react if we miss a goal, fail a test or come last in a race?

ADVANCED PREPARATION

FEELINGS ASSEMBLY 2

FEELING AWAKE

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● Full Of The Joys!
- It's A Spring Thing!
- As The Sun Rises
- Sing Yourself A Happy Song
- Because It's Springtime!

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To reflect on what is needed to be 'awake and ready for action' in school

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Image of a sleeping giraffe
- YouTube animation of The Parable of the Sower

ENGAGE

INVITE an adult and a child to pretend to be asleep in front of the assembly. Ask a child to 'wake' them up. The adult yawns and sluggishly comes to life, stretching and groaning. The child leaps into action, runs on the spot and does star jumps.

ASK Which person seems to be more ready for action for the day ahead?

WONDER

DISPLAY an image of a sleeping giraffe.

ASK How much sleep does a giraffe need in one day? (*About half an hour a day due to threat of predators and difficulty lying down.*)

ASK How much sleep should you have in one day? (*Advice for 6-13 year olds is 9-11 hours.*)

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK

PARTNER What do you need to do in order to be awake and ready for action at school, ready to learn and to participate?

GATHER FEEDBACK

BE STILL One

minute of stillness Sit comfortably, close your eyes gently and feel your breath, in, out, in, out. Breathe normally, gently. Feel your tummy moving as you breathe. Feel the floor beneath you. Relax your hands, unclench your fingers. Focus on your breathing, in, out, in, out.

RESPOND

EXPLAIN The seeds that grew the best found good soil, which was watered, fed with fertiliser and had plenty of sunlight and space in the field. We are all a bit like the seeds. We need to be in a good place if we are to do well at school.

REFLECT Think back over the last twelve hours or so. Did you sleep well? Did you eat a healthy breakfast? Did you walk or cycle to school? Have you done exercise or been out in the fresh air? What could you do better to be ready for action at school?

DISPLAY The Parable of the Sower (Mark 4 v 1-8) You Tube animation: [youtube.com/watch?v=Tb7bvF5Ucrk](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Tb7bvF5Ucrk)

OR READ from a Children's Bible, the Parable of the Sower, Mark 4 v 1-8.

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Wake up! Wake up! Give yourself a shake up!'

May we be good learners today, no matter how we're feeling;

Wake up! etc.

May we be good listeners today and not become distracted;

Wake up! etc.

May we be good helpers today, sharing our ideas and helping others to learn; **Wake up! etc. Amen.**

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER What stops us from being the best learners we can be?

How can we improve our sleep and make sure we get enough rest time?

Can we make good choices to improve our diet and drink more water?

How can we change our lifestyle to include more exercise and fresh air?

FEELINGS ASSEMBLY 3

FEELING GOOD

SONG CHOICES:

- A Perfect Day In Spring
- Songbird ● Caterpillar Munch
- It's A Spring Thing!
- The Tadpole Song
- As The Sun Rises
- Sing Yourself A Happy Song
- Full Of The Joys!

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Image of a herd of zebra or a school of whales

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To consider that we are each valuable because we are loved by God

ENGAGE

INVITE pairs of friends to answer questions about each other: Do they have a pet? Do they like cabbage? Do they do any sports? What colour are their eyes? How many hairs are on their head?

EXPLAIN We may know a lot about our friends, but Christians believe that only God knows every detail of our lives, because he planned us and created us to be unique individuals.

WONDER

DISPLAY an image of a herd of zebra or a school of whales.

EXPLAIN that every zebra's stripe pattern is unique and every whale's tail print is unique.

Every human being is unique too.
Your fingerprints are not the same as anyone else's!

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK PARTNER Compare your fingerprint with your partner's fingerprint. See if you can spot the differences.

BIBLE BIT

This is a poem from the Bible that tells us that God knows everything about us.

READ Psalm 139 v 1-4
Lord, you know all about me. You know when I sit down and when I get up. You know my thoughts before I think them. You know where I go and where I lie down. You know well everything I do. Lord, even before I say a word, you already know what I am going to say.

RESPOND

Children respond with: 'I'm a special child of God.'

Whether I play football or whether I dance; **I'm a special child of God.**

Whether I am short or whether I am tall; **I'm a special child of God.**

Whether I am happy or whether I am sad; **I'm a special child of God.**

Every day in every way; **I'm a special child of God.**

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Amen.'

Creator God, thank you that we are all different and we are all special.

Thank you that we each have different skills and talents.

Thank you that we are all equally loved and valued as your children.

Amen.

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER What can we do to help others feel more valuable?

REFLECT Think of one thing you could do to encourage someone today who might be feeling worthless, e.g. being kind to someone who is left out at playtime; friendship with someone new in school; plan an activity in school to fundraise for a charity that helps the elderly or the homeless; talk at home about a neighbour who might appreciate a visit.

MODERATE PREPARATION

FESTIVALS ASSEMBLY 1

EGGS GALORE!

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- Caterpillar Munch
- The Tadpole Song
- We're Making Pancakes
- Ring Out The Bells!
- He Is Risen (Easter Blessing)

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To reflect on the symbolism of eggs in springtime festivals

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- An uncooked hen's egg ready to crack open
- A glass/transparent bowl
- Images of an ostrich egg and a butterfly/moth egg on a leaf

ENGAGE

Hold up the hen's egg.

ASK What do you think might be inside here?

GATHER

FEEDBACK

Chick, yolk, white, raw egg or other answers relating to baby dinosaurs, snakes etc.

ASK How can we find out? *Crack open the egg and pour the raw egg into the glass/bowl.*

COMMENT

I'm quite relieved/ disappointed we didn't find a baby dinosaur!

WONDER

DISPLAY image of the ostrich egg.

AND ASK What might be inside this egg?

DISPLAY image of the butterfly or moth egg.

AND ASK What might hatch out of this egg?

NOTE: Caterpillars or larvae hatch, NOT butterflies or moths. Pupils might respond with 'ant' or other small insect, which are reasonable answers, given that nearly all insect life emerges from eggs.

TALK ABOUT

WITH TALK

PARTNER How many different animals can you think of that hatch from eggs? (*Birds, insects, reptiles.*)

EXPLAIN

Eggs are important in springtime as they symbolize the potential for new life: the new animal has not yet hatched, but eggs remind us that life is possible within an egg.

ASK But what about this egg that I have cracked into the bowl? What can it become? A cake or pancake? (*Option to add milk and flour and whisk to make a batter if near Pancake Day.*)

BIBLE BIT

These words of Jesus in the Bible remind us that eggs are good. They bring life and can be used to make delicious food for us to eat.

READ

Luke 11 v 12. What would your parents do if you asked for fish for dinner? Would they give you a snake? Or, if you asked for a fried egg, would they give you a crispy scorpion? Even your parents know how to give you good food to eat, so how much more will God give you good gifts?

RESPOND

1) FOR PANCAKE DAY

On Pancake Day we use eggs to make pancakes. Christians believe that when Lent starts it is a time to stop treating ourselves and try to treat others well, to show love for God.

REFLECT How could you treat someone else well this Lent time?

OR 2) FOR EASTER

At Easter, eggs are eaten. Christians remember that Jesus died and rose from the dead, bringing the gift of new life with Him. It is as if He has hatched from the tomb into new life with God.*

REFLECT If you were hatching from an egg, what would you do with your new life?

* Option to crack open a chocolate egg and show the empty 'tomb'.

PRAYER

Children respond

with: 'Help us to do all things well.'

Father God, we thank you for all good gifts;

Help us to do all things well.

Thank you for the possibility of new life and fresh opportunities; **Help us to do all things well.**

Show us how we can 'hatch' into being the best people we can be; **Help us to do all things well. Amen.**

GO DEEPER

EXPLAIN

Jewish people place an egg (hard-boiled) on the special Seder plate for the Passover meal when they are recalling the story of the Jews being set free from slavery, when they had to leave Egypt quickly and had little time to prepare their meals.

ASK What other foods do Jewish people eat to remind them of their freedom? (Unleavened bread, roast lamb, bitter herbs, salt water.)

ADVANCED PREPARATION

FESTIVALS ASSEMBLY 2

GOOD OR SAD FRIDAY?

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- April Showers
- As The Sun Rises
- Ring Out The Bells!
- He Is Risen (Easter Blessing)

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To explore whether Easter is a sad or happy time

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Slideshow of images as per 'Wonder' column
- A personal story as in the 'Engage' column
- Slide with Bible passage without underlining

ENGAGE

ASK What has been the happiest day of your life so far?

THEN EITHER ASK

Has anyone ever been admitted to hospital? Take feedback, drawing attention to the unpleasant sides of the stories and affirming any 'happy' endings that are mentioned.

OR TELL

a story of a very dark day. It was dark because it was sad and difficult. Tell a personal story of an accident, illness or other sad event. Delay talking about its positive outcome until later in the assembly. (Be especially sensitive to known situations of terminal illness or long-term conditions which may not have 'happy' endings.)

WONDER

Practise making sad and happy facial expressions.

DISPLAY

images on separate slides that include: birthday balloons, an injured animal, plastic pollution, newborn lambs, a child smiling in a hospital bed, a graveyard, Christ on the cross, a cloud with light shining behind it.

INVITE the children to use a facial expression in response to each slide. Pause at those that are intentionally ambiguous to discuss both aspects.

EXPLAIN 'Every cloud has a silver lining'. That hard times can often work out well in the end. (If a personal story was used in the 'Engage' section, refer now to its 'happy' ending if applicable.)

TALK ABOUT

EXPLAIN The day on which Christians recall that Jesus was killed by crucifixion is called Good Friday.

ASK Why is a day with a sad event called 'Good'?

WITH TALK

PARTNER Think of one reason why Christians believe that the day Jesus died was a 'good' day.

GATHER FEEDBACK

BIBLE BIT

LISTEN to these words from the Bible. See if you can work out which words show that Jesus dying on the cross could be a 'good' thing.

READ

1 Corinthians 1 v 18. The story of Jesus dying on the cross is crazy to those people who do not understand, but to those who want to be saved, it shows the loving power of God.

GATHER FEEDBACK

Draw attention to the underlined words.

RESPOND

EXPLAIN

'Every cloud has a silver lining' could be used to describe the clouds that covered the afternoon sky on the day Jesus died.

When Jesus died on the cross, Christians believe He was fighting a battle against all the bad stuff in the world, so that it wouldn't have power any longer. Then, three days later, Jesus rose from the dead to demonstrate that He had won the battle!

REFLECT

What challenges do I face at the moment that are difficult?

PRAYER

DISPLAY

Image of the cloud with the 'silver lining' (displayed at the end of the images in the 'Wonder' column).

Children look at the image and respond with 'Amen'.

Lord Jesus, when you died it was a dark afternoon, but it didn't stay dark and you didn't stay dead.

Help me with my

challenges to wait patiently for the light to come.

Amen.

GO DEEPER

CONSIDER

How we can sometimes feel overwhelmed by problems at home or at school and they can have a powerful impact on our lives.

WITH TALK

PARTNER

How can the impact of problems be reduced and removed by sharing worries and problems?

EXPLAIN

There are courses of action, people to turn to, to talk to and sources of support.

MODERATE PREPARATION

FESTIVALS ASSEMBLY 3

EASTER MESSAGE

SONG CHOICES:

- Goodbye Winter, Hello Spring!
- As The Sun Rises
- Ring Out The Bells!
- He Is Risen (Easter Blessing)

OBJECTIVE OF COLLECTIVE WORSHIP:

To consider the special message of Easter

RESOURCES NEEDED:

- Slide containing coded message OR prepare to deliver a coded message in British Sign Language, semaphore or something similar
- Easter Morning Responsive Story, Appendix 3, page 125

ENGAGE

DISPLAY Deliver a coded message for 'He's alive!' in one of the following suggested ways: morse code; semaphore, British Sign Language, a number code where A=1, B=2 etc. or as a Chinese-whispers game.

Pupils attempt to decipher the code, but if this proves difficult, use this to suggest the idea of the Easter message being mysterious.

WONDER

EXPLAIN Christians believe that Jesus died when He was crucified on the cross. Christians remember this on Good Friday and often go to church to reflect on this special day.

I WONDER what you believe happened next to Jesus.

WITH TALK

PARTNER Discuss what you believe happened to Jesus after he died on the cross.

TALK ABOUT

EXPLAIN Christians believe that on the third day after He had been killed, Jesus rose from the dead and would stay alive for ever. This is called the resurrection.

WITH TALK

PARTNER Tell your partner what you find to be the hardest thing to believe about the Easter story and why. Listen to your partner's ideas too.

BIBLE BIT

For over 2000 years, at Easter time, Christians have celebrated Jesus returning from death to life. However, it is not always easy for everyone to believe. Listen to this story and think about which group of people you might belong to.

READ

Easter Morning Responsive Story (Appendix 3, page 125).

Children respond with 'Oh wow!' with varying expression.

RESPOND

Some amazing events are retold in that story and they show how special Jesus is. Think about what you believe as you respond again with the words 'Oh wow!'

The stone was rolled away! **Oh wow!**

The tomb was empty! **Oh wow!**

An angel spoke! **Oh wow!**

Jesus appeared to his friends and talked to them! **Oh wow!**

Jesus must be alive! **Oh wow!**

PRAYER

Children respond with: 'Amen'.

Dear God, when we can't see you, help us believe.

When we can't hear you, help us believe.

When we can't feel you, help us believe.

Help us this Easter to believe that Jesus is alive!

Amen.

GO DEEPER

EXPLAIN The special message of Easter is about the power of life over death, or maybe the power of love over death.

WITH TALK PARTNER

Compose a tweet or short text message (maximum of 15 words) to pass on the special message of what has happened on Easter morning.

Share a few with the assembly.